

The cover art is a stylized illustration in a dark, moody color palette. It features two characters: a woman with long, flowing blonde hair and a man with short, dark, curly hair and pointed ears. Both are dressed in dark, elegant clothing with long sleeves and capes. They are positioned in a garden filled with large, vibrant red flowers, possibly tulips or orchids. The woman is on the left, looking down, while the man is on the right, looking towards the viewer. The background is dark with intricate, swirling patterns. The title 'THE ORCHID HEIST' is prominently displayed in the upper center in a large, white, serif font, set against a dark rectangular background.

THE ORCHID HEIST

A 4TH LEVEL ADVENTURE
COMPATIBLE WITH 5TH EDITION

BY CORKBOARDS & CURIOSITIES

CREDITS

THE DUNGEONTUBER'S DUNGEON JAM

This adventure was written for the 2025 Dungeon Jam, a megacollab organised and coordinated by:
Mystic Arts, Knigobi, PaladinProse and Lunatic Dice

During this event, dozens of TTRPG content creators on youtube created and released ready-to-play 5 room dungeons adventures, inspired by the work of Johnn Four. To access the full playlist, click [here](#).

A video walkthrough of this adventure is also available [here](#).

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PREPARATION

A PLAYER PRIMER

Read carefully, for this scroll will self destruct 2 minutes after opening. Your expertise is requested for a mission of the highest urgency. A priceless orchid was stolen from a community of sprites, and needs retrieving right away.

We cannot stress enough how precious this orchid is, and how vital it is that it is returned as quickly as possible. During tonight's gala, you will infiltrate Destiny's Gardens, hotspot for wealthy aristocrats, and headquarters of the city's most successful brand of pharmaceuticals. If anyone can pull this heist, it's you. We're counting on you.

PREPARING YOUR PLAYERS FOR THIS ADVENTURE

Themes of self-image, confidence and insecurities related to one's appearance are central to this adventure, and the driving force for the horror atmosphere of this particular location and villain.

These themes can also be the catalyst for roleplay that grants insight into PCs' minds and emotions, engaging roleplay driven players by confronting their characters with their own inner demons.

Prior to running the adventure, ask each player the following questions:

What is your character's greatest insecurity, and why?

What does this insecurity mean to them?

Do they want to "fix" this perceived flaw? And if so, how far would they go to achieve that?

A character may think they are not strong enough to protect those they care about, not imposing enough to be taken seriously, not precise enough, not wealthy enough... Encourage your players to consider what these themes mean to each of their characters, and remember this information. A player character's **greatest insecurity** will come into play throughout the adventure, as the villain tries to exploit it and use it against them.

However, the goal is to play with the characters' insecurities, not that of the players. To ensure that the game stays enjoyable for all players at the table, be sensible with your approach. Do not hesitate to discuss with your players and figure out boundaries together.

OVERVIEW

A NOTE ON TONE

The desire to be loved, to belong, to be respected and cared for, is an ever hungry beast. Left to simmer in its own dissatisfaction, it misguidedly blames whatever innocent victim it can find. A voice too timid, an aging skin, a frame judged too frail. Learning to tame that creature, to feed and appease it, is a mark of great wisdom. Learning to enable the creature, to starve it and command it to cause harm for personal gain, is among the greatest cruelties. But oh, how sweet the rewards, and the power they give me, as they beg me to protect from the beast I sent their way.

DESTINY'S EMPIRE

To socialites in the big city, presenting with confidence is a necessity, regardless of the festering insecurities that they hide away under layers of perfume and expensive clothes. Destiny, a hag in disguise with a sharp entrepreneurial spirit, saw opportunity in this masquerade.

The success of her magical cosmetics business grew her brand into nothing short of a beauty empire. Selling a variety of cosmetics and concoctions with remarkable properties, Destiny sells self-improvement, and the dream of becoming one's best self. Some products temporarily block the effects of aging, while others magically enhance one's eloquence or overall desirability. Preying on people's insecurities, Destiny's remedies soon create dependency. Her upper class clients always crave more, and Destiny revels in cultivating their ever-increasing hatred for their own reflection.

Her headquarters are located in a well-off neighbourhood, harboring labs and a shop, as well as an open-for-visit greenhouse in which the high society gathers in public view.

THE STOLEN ORCHID

Unbeknownst to clients, such products require dubious ingredients.

For her new line of cosmetics, which she will announce tonight at a gala held in the greenhouse, Destiny required a particularly powerful component. She scored an orchid from a remote community of wild sprites. Held within the flower are sprite eggs, whose inherent magic is capable of reversing age or curing illness, and which she aims to harvest.

The sprites immediately sought to retrieve their soon-to-be-born offsprings, and sent two of their own, Pandora and Ulberic. They have so far been unable to enter Destiny's greenhouse: expecting the fairies to come for the orchid, the hag installed wards to keep them away. Ulberic and Pandora resorted to hiring adventurers to infiltrate the greenhouse in their stead, while studying and scouting the building to be as helpful as possible.

Though they do not know of Destiny's true nature and intentions, and "feel it in their heart" that the orchid hasn't been harmed, they assume the worst.



NON PLAYER CHARACTERS

- **Destiny.** Though truly a hag, the world knows her as a pretty, young and bubbly businesswoman, turned into a successful public figure thanks to her ambition and pioneering spirit. With a sweet voice and an outgoing energy, she preaches that she aims to help everyone become their best self, and is an expert at backhanded compliments.
- **Pandora.** An explosive and stubborn sprite, frustrated that she is unable to go rescue the eggs herself. Quick to sass and easily impatient, she was among the sprites assigned to watch over the orchid when it was stolen. Even though magic prevented her from moving and defending the flower, she believes that she failed to protect the orchid and is taking it to heart.
- **Ulberic.** A level headed people pleaser, this sprite seems meek in comparison to Pandora. His own child is held within the orchid, and he will go to great lengths to ensure their safe return, offering to sacrifice part of his magic in order to provide the adventurers with magic tools to aid them in their mission.
- **Dr. Nataniel Mirville.** More frazzled than a grad school student during finals, the head of lab is a timid young man surviving on coffee and stress-induced adrenaline. He could easily land a prestigious position elsewhere, but is trapped in a deal with Destiny, physically unable to leave the labs, in which he has lived for the past 4 years (see Tier 4: the manuscript). Though secretly researching ways to expose Destiny and free himself, he remains forced to work for her.

ADVENTURE HOOKS

This adventure begins in an abandoned apartment overlooking the greenhouse, which the sprites have adopted as their temporary headquarters. The characters may have landed there in one or several of the following ways:

- A character with previous experience in crime and infiltration receives a message from an old contact: they heard of a job, it seems to be... a weird one. But likely worth it. The address of the abandoned apartment is provided.
- In a shady bar, characters are approached by a silhouette clad in a black hoodie, standing on the table and no taller than their mug of ale. It is Ulberic, looking to hire.
- The characters awaken in a dark room, their hands and feet bound to a chair, with a canvas bag over their heads. As they come to, they can hear two hushed voices nervously arguing. Ulberic profusely apologises while untying their bounds, worried that using magical sleep dust to kidnap them was not the best way to convince adventurers to help, whereas Pandora insists that they never would have taken them seriously otherwise.

TIERS OF THE ADVENTURE

This adventure unfolds in 5 tiers, reflecting both the progress of the party towards the Vault, and the level of risk involved if they get caught during their infiltration:

TIER 1: the Plan	Studying the blueprints, picking gadgets, scouting and planning
TIER 2: the Gala	Entering the greenhouse, exploring the areas open to the public
TIER 3: Infiltration	Exploring the labs and restricted access areas
TIER 4: the Lair	Infiltrating the secret lair, breaking Destiny's spells, unlocking the Vault
TIER 5: Resolution	Acquiring the Orchid, defeating Destiny, or accepting her deal

MAP REFERENCE

The entirety of the building, except for the loading dock, is protected by **Sigil Wards** keeping away sprites, which can be disabled in the *Lair*.

GROUND FLOOR

Areas accessible to the public:

3 **security guards** patrolling, 1 waitstaff **employee** circulating in the greenhouses and carrying items from the *café menu*.

ENTRANCE AND LOBBY

- 1 **employee** at the front desk.
- › **Door (east):** leads to the *staff break room*, locked and accessible with a **staff key**.
- › **Elevator:** Leads to the *lounge*. The elevator also opens on the north side into the *central greenhouse*.

SHOP

- 2 **employees**
- *Destiny's enchanted cosmetics*
- Walls lined with **vicious mirrors** (DC 15 Charisma saving throw)
- › **Dumbwaiter:** located behind the counter, it delivers products from *manufacturing* and is big enough for a tiny creature to squeeze into (marked with red triangle on the map).

POWDER ROOM

- Walls lined with **vicious mirrors** (DC 15 Charisma saving throw)

CENTRAL GREENHOUSE

- › **Balcony:** in plain view and 15 ft. from the ground, leads to *Destiny's office*.

EAST GREENHOUSE CAFÉ

- 1 waitstaff **employee** carrying items from the *café menu*.



TOWERS

- Walls lined with **vicious mirrors** (DC 15 Charisma saving throw)

Areas S: staff-only areas.

STAFF BREAK ROOM

- › **Staircase:** *Lab corridor*
- › **Door (west):** leads to the *lobby*, locked and accessible with a **staff key**.

STAFF LOCKER ROOM & STORAGE

- Spare **staff key**
- 6 lab coats
- 1 pitchfork, can serve as a **trident**.

KITCHENS

Deserted most of the time, but the 2 waitstaff **employees** frequently come here to refill their trays.

- Items from the *café menu*

LOADING DOCK

Used by wagons delivering or picking up goods from the greenhouse.

- Empty wagon
- › **Door (north):** leads to the *kitchens*, locked and accessible with a **staff key**.
- › **Door (south):** leads to *storage*, locked and accessible with a **staff key**.

FIRST FLOOR

Area accessible to the public:

LOUNGE

Couches are set up in this area, which mostly serves as a waiting room for Destiny's office.

- 1 **employee** on janitor duty, cleaning the space.
- › **Door (east):** Leads to *Destiny's office*, locked and accessible with a **passage gem**.
- › **Door (south):** Leads to *lab corridor*, locked and accessible with a **staff key**.
- › **Elevator:** Leads to the *lobby* or the *central greenhouse*.

Staff-only areas:

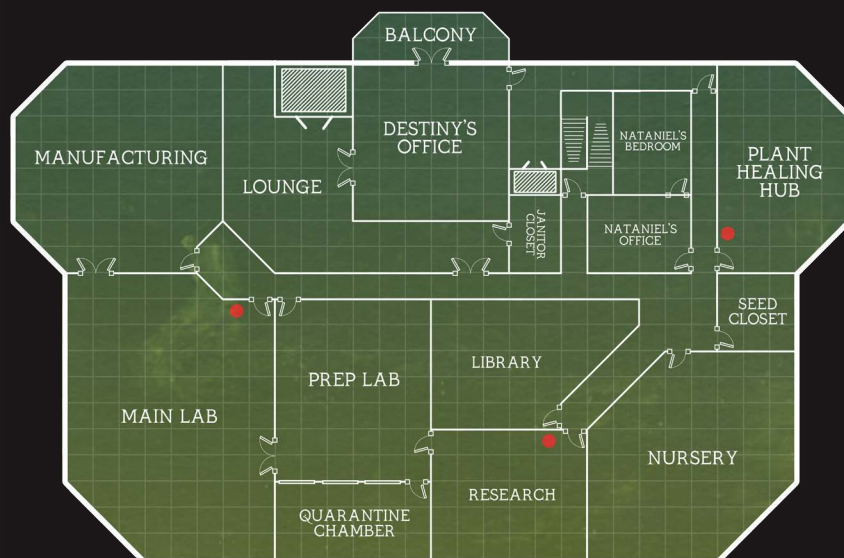
3 **alert bells** hooked to the walls (marked with red dot on the map), 1 **security guard** patrolling.

LAB CORRIDOR

- › **Door (north):** Leads to *high security corridor*, locked and accessible with a **passage gem**.
- › **Staircase:** *staff break room*.

LABS (ALL)

- **Encounters in the labs** table.



NATANIEL OFFICE/BEDROOM

- Nataniel's **journal**
- **Shortsword**

MANUFACTURING

- **Nataniel**
- › **Dumbwaiter:** Delivers products to the *shop*, and is big enough for a tiny creature to squeeze into

HIGH SECURITY CORRIDOR

- › **Door (south):** *lab corridor*, locked and only accessible with a **passage gem**.
- › **Elevator:** leads to the *lair*.

DESTINY'S OFFICE

- Spare **passage key**
- **Ledger** detailing Destiny's transactions with high profile citizens, as well as their debt.
- **Destiny's Herbarium**
- › **Door (west):** Leads to *lounge*, locked and accessible with a **passage gem**.
- › **Door (east):** Leads to *high security corridor*, locked and accessible with a **passage gem**.
- › **Balcony:** in plain view and 15 ft. from the ground, leads to *central greenhouse*.

BASEMENT

The basement is a secret location and does not appear on the blueprints given to the PCs in Tier 1.

LAIR

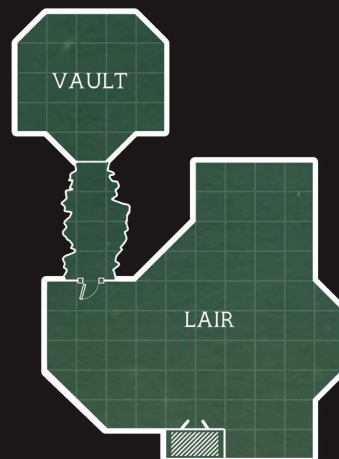
Contains Destiny's active spells and rituals. They can be disabled but she will be immediately alerted.

- **Sigil Ward** currently set with Lazare Orchids, keeping away sprites.
- **Heart of the Vicious Mirrors** containing information on Destiny's clients' insecurities.

- Nataniel's **manuscript**.
- Staff's locks of hair, keeping them trapped in a fairy bargain.
- › **Elevator:** *high security corridor*
- › **Rotting door:** the **Sleeping Room** puzzle, guarding *the Vault*.

VAULT

- **A letter** containing instructions to turn sprite eggs into a youth elixir.
- The stolen **Orchid** and **sprite eggs**.



TIER 1

THE PLAN

THE SPRITES' BRIEFING

Ulberic and Pandora can provide the following information:

- An orchid was stolen from their community, located a couple of days walk away from the city. It was not taken by accident: its guardians were frozen immobile with magic, and the flower was gone when they finally freed themselves. A sprite seer managed to locate the orchid's essence: it is held within the Greenhouse.
- Once Ulberic and Pandora arrived in town, wards had already been set up to prevent sprites from entering the building. The magic in these wards, as well as the aura surrounding the greenhouse, seems shockingly similar to fey magic, which the sprites find alarming.
- While investigating in the city, they found out that while a popular spot for leisurely visits, the building also houses the headquarters, labs and main selling location of a luxury brand focusing on cosmetics and self improvement.
- A garden party will be held in the building tonight to celebrate the launch of a new line of products, which hopefully should work in the party's advantage. In the midst of a party, employees will likely be busier than usual. Attendees will naturally require fancy attire, which the sprites can procure for the party.
- It is of utmost importance that the Orchid is returned to the sprites intact and as urgently as possible. The Orchid is their sole concern: anything else that the characters steal during the mission is theirs to keep.

OPTIONAL EVENT: SECRET BOUND

Characters may insist on knowing what is so special about this orchid. At the GM's discretion, the sprites might decide that they want some form of guarantee before telling. If a character truly wishes to know, they can enter a fey bargain with Pandora by giving her a lock of their hair, after which she will reveal what is held within the orchid.

A character who enters this bargain sees a purple ring form on the skin around their wrists. As long as the deal is active, sharing the secret will cause them to take 6d6 psychic damage on a failed **DC 16 Wisdom saving throw**, or half as much on a successful one. Additionally, any damage they deal to the orchid carries out to them.

This fey bargain ends once the egg is returned safely to Ulberic and Pandora. The deal also ends if the lock of hair is destroyed, if the fey that issued the bargain dies, or chooses to release the character.

PLANNING THE HEIST

The following is available during the setup tier of the heist:

- The sprites managed to acquire the **blueprints of the greenhouse** by infiltrating the town hall prior to the mission (see *Handout: Player Blueprints*).
- Ulberic has volunteered to sacrifice his magic in order to infuse it into useful devices (see *Handout: Gadgets*). He has enough power to enchant 3 items chosen by the group. After doing so, he will be unable to use his heart sight and invisibility for a week. Note that during the gala, weapons or armor will need to be concealed, or left behind.
- Characters may want to scout or stakeout the building. During tier 1, there is only time for one skill check per character. Refer to the general information table.

SNEAKING WEAPONS INTO THE GALA

Most aristocrats and socialites would consider bringing bloodied weapons to an upscale event as a dreadful social faux-pas... and an immediate threat to their safety. Characters entering the Gala with visible weapons or armor will immediately arouse suspicion. Security guards and employees keep an eye out, and will address those who break the rule as soon as they are noticed, escorting them out should they refuse to comply and leave their weapons in the employee's care for the duration of the event.

The party can circumvent this issue in several ways. Ceremonial or official weapons and gear are permitted for high rank individuals such as decorated officers. A character can convince employees that they qualify for this exemption with a successful **DC 15 Charisma (Deception) check**, so long as their gear looks the part. Alternatively, the party may sneak weapons into the event by hiding them in their gala attire and succeeding on a contested **Dexterity (Sleight of hand) check** against the employee or security guard's Wisdom (Perception) check.

GENERAL INFORMATION TABLE

By default, the following information applies in the building. Though there is only time for one ability check per character during the planning phase, discovering this information will remain available to the party in the next tiers.

Required skill check and DC	Information acquired
DC 5 Wisdom (Perception)	There are 3 security guards patrolling inside the public areas of the building. Their uniforms are plain golden masks, white gloves, and cream colored suits with green filigree.
DC 5 Wisdom (Insight)	The great majority of attendees seems very concerned with being perceived as wealthy or influential, and don't hesitate to show off.
DC 5 Intelligence (Investigation)	The two waiters frequently go into the kitchen. The door is unlocked, so to not inconvenience their passage when their hands are full with trays of food.
DC 10 Wisdom (Insight)	While they talk with enthusiasm and a bright smile when talking to clients, the employees don't seem as cheerful when they think no one is watching.
DC 10 Wisdom (Perception)	Most of the attendees' physical traits look so "perfect" that it is almost uncanny. Skin entirely lacks texture, and faces barely move when emoting.
DC 15 Wisdom (Insight)	Several visitors tend to react strangely to the mirrors in the greenhouse. Some avert their eyes, avoiding their reflection, others can't help but nervously check themselves in the mirror from time to time.
DC 15 Intelligence (Investigation)	A portrait shows Destiny with her team. Beside her are 4 security guards and 7 employees (6 of them can be encountered in the public areas of the greenhouse. The 7th person is Nataniel, who never leaves the labs).
DC 15 Wisdom (Perception)	Employees bear a green ring on the skin around their wrist. They will not talk about it, and may call security on a persistent character. If they accepted Pandora's deal, the party immediately recognizes it as a fairy bargain.
DC 20 Wisdom (Perception)	The uniforms entirely cover the guards' skin, but for a split second, the fabric parts enough to reveal oddly colored skin, between green and grey.

EMPLOYEES OF THE GREENHOUSE

Except for Nataniel who is bound to the labs, Destiny's employees are botanists and gardeners by trade, but carry out any role that Destiny assigns to them. For the gala, all 6 of them have been assigned to various hosting duties:

- 1 employee greets attendees in the lobby.
- 2 employees serve drinks and snacks to the attendees. One is stationed in the café, while the other circulates in the greenhouses with a tray. Both frequently make trips to the kitchen to fetch more snacks. Eating an item from the menu (see *Appendix: Café menu*) causes a small change in appearance, which amuses the visitors.
- 2 employees run the shop, enthusiastically advising clients on products to try out. All of **Destiny's magical products**, along with their properties, are detailed in the *Appendix*.
- 1 employee is on janitor duty, cleaning the lounge on the first floor.

All employees carry a **staff key**, and bear a ring of green on the skin around their wrists, which while hidden under their sleeves, can be spotted with a successful **DC 15 Wisdom (Perception) check**. A fairy bargain with the hag prevents them from speaking of the company's true nature without taking 6d6 psychic damage. When conversation stirs too close to secrets they must keep, they respond with the same phrase: *"I'm afraid that sharing this information goes against our confidentiality policy"*. If threatened, they seek out a security agent. However, if the party gains their trust and convinces them that they can free them, either through convincing words or a successful **DC 17 Charisma (Persuasion) check**, employees may try to help by dancing around the truth.

PREYING ON INSECURITIES

Destiny has set up enchantments to influence visitors and prey on their self image related fears.

- The mirrors in the powder room, the lobby, the lounge and the towers are **vicious mirrors** (see *Tier 4: Vicious mirrors*), enchanted to use a person's fear against them. A character failing a **DC 15 Wisdom saving throw** while near the mirrors sees their reflection slightly distorted to match their main insecurity. Only the affected character sees this distortion.
- Each time a character enters the lobby, the main greenhouse, the shop or the towers for the first time, they must make a **DC 15 Wisdom saving throw**. On a failure, Destiny's **vicious mirrors** learn the character's **greatest insecurity**, and the character can no longer be targeted by this effect. Succeeding on this save shows a normal reflection, and grants advantage on the next roll against this effect.
- Consuming drinks or pastries from the **Café menu** gives a disadvantage on these saves.

DESTINY'S SECURITY AGENTS

3 **security guards** patrol on the ground floor. One is stationed in the shop, and the other two circle through the greenhouses. The 4th and last security guard stayed in the labs. All carry a **staff key** and a **passage gem** in their vest pocket.

These former clients of Destiny had to forfeit their soul to pay the debt accumulated for their "cosmetic treatments". A sickly plant-based poison pulses through their veins, keeping them alive. Now nearly mindless husks, they obey the commands of Destiny, who can telepathically speak to them, though they cannot respond.

Suits, gloves and golden masks cover their skin. Though instructed never to remove these while in the public areas of the greenhouse, they may do so with a bonus action if circumstances require them to claw and bite.

They do not speak to visitors unless absolutely necessary. When they do, it is in very few words, and with a raspy guttural voice.

RUMORS AMONG THE ATTENDEES

Nearly a hundred of attendees are present during the gala. They are all relatively well-off individuals, with curated appearances and well rehearsed manners. They can be found in any of the greenhouses, in the shop, in the lobby or in the powder room.

Charisma check threshold	Information acquired from the attendees
5	Destiny has touched many lives. It seems everyone has a story about an insecurity they once had that is now "cured" thanks to her products.
10	There's a rumor going around that Destiny's new line of products is going to be anti-aging cosmetics more potent than anyone has ever created.
15	The visitor they are talking to is an undercover journalist, who noticed that Destiny's Remedies can be addictive and came to investigate.
20	A regular spotted a ring of green on the skin of several employees' wrists, but has no idea what they are. Maybe it's part of a new product line.
25	Someone saw something glowing through the vest of a security guard. Whatever is in their pocket, it's gotta be valuable.

MEETING DESTINY

By default at the start of the adventure, Destiny is in her office. Some time after the beginning of the gala, she appears at her balcony to welcome the attendees to the event before joining the festivities downstairs. She mingles with the visitors for the rest of the evening, where characters may have a chance to interact with her.

- Destiny is an expert at subtle backhanded compliments. She sounds bubbly and friendly, but looks for opportunities within each conversation to create new insecurities. For example, she may enthusiastically compliment someone on their makeup skills, mentioning that it makes their nose "appear slimmer than it is".
- The brand's image and narrative are meticulously curated, and there is no room for disruption. If confronted in public with questions she does not want to answer, Destiny's priority is to maintain the facade. She does not lose her temper easily, preferring to de-escalate, or at most, have the troublemakers escorted outside.
- If she becomes suspicious of someone, Destiny may assign security to follow from a distance.

Note that Destiny is immune to effects sensing her thoughts or emotions, and that Wisdom (Insight) checks aimed at discerning her intentions or sincerity have disadvantage.

PROGRESSING TO TIER 3

Tier 2 concludes when the party enters the staff restricted areas, either via the staff break room, the kitchens, the lounge, the shop's dumbwaiter or the storage room. This can be done in a variety of ways, including:

- Stealing a staff key from employees.
- Lockpicking any of the doors to the staff areas.
- Sneaking through the kitchen doors from the café.
- Intimidating, bribing or persuading an employee.
- Shrinking in size to sneakily climb through the shop's dumbwaiter.

TIER 3

INFILTRATION

STAFF ONLY AREAS OVERVIEW

The following applies by default in this tier:

PEOPLE

- On the ground floor, the staff only areas are deserted, except for the kitchen in which the 2 **employees** on waitstaff duty frequently refill their trays.
- **Nataniel** works in the manufacturing lab on the first floor. Employees in the shop send requests up via the dumbwaiter, and Nataniel sends the appropriate products back to them. If he crosses the threshold into the lounge, the staircase or the highly restricted areas, he suffers 3d6 psychic damage per round until he returns to the labs.
- A **security guard** patrols through the labs.
- While employees may be persuaded or intimidated before resorting to combat, security guards immediately attack any intruders found in the labs area, unless they are wearing **lab coats**, tricking the guard.

INFRASTRUCTURE

- The storage and locker rooms on the ground floor contain items that may be useful: 6 **lab coats** and a pitchfork that can be used as a **trident**.
- In the labs, 3 **alert bells** are fixed on different walls. Red dots indicate their location on the GM map. Each bears a sign with the words "alert protocol". Ringing these bells alerts Destiny and all her security guards with a ping in their mind. They are mostly used to alert when a specimen becomes hostile in the labs, but staff may also use them in case of intruders.
- At the end of a long corridor to the west of the plant healing hub, a door is marked with the words "highly restricted access". Unlike the other staff-only areas, this door and the western door into Destiny's office do not open with a staff key. Instead, a passage gem must be pressed into a slot to the side of the door.

ENCOUNTERS IN THE LABS

The truth of Destiny's labs is far from the facade that she curated. The labs have no windows, and the ingredients are disgusting at best, sentient and in pain at worse. Some plants are plagued with pulsing purple pustules, while others have been fused with pieces of flesh and mutated into grotesque distortions of themselves.

Whenever the party searches a room in the lab department for the first time, roll or choose from this table:

d6	Encounter
1	Searching through the lab tools, a particularly large scalpel can be turned into a makeshift dagger .
2	A tray holds 3 doses of a remedy, selected at random among Destiny's magical products .
3	A potion of healing is tucked in a cabinet.
4	Enough supplies can be gathered to form a complete Herbalism kit .
5	A line has been drawn with chalk on the floor. A character crossing that line enters the range of a nearby awakened shrub , which immediately attacks.
6	A large glass bell jar has fogged over from whatever is inside. Lifting the bell jar disturbs the shrieker held within, alerting anyone on this floor.

THE TRAPPED RESEARCHER

Dr Nataniel Mirville, head of labs, can be found in the manufacturing lab. Not having seen anyone other than his coworkers since his deal with the hag 4 years ago, the party's arrival catches him by surprise. If they are hostile to him, he seeks out a **security guard** to deal with them, or runs to the nearest **alert bell**. Otherwise, desperate after years of entrapment, he recognises the group's arrival as his best chance to finally defeat Destiny. He can help by healing them and by providing the following information:

- Destiny is a hag, and uses her products to prey on insecurities and cultivate her clients' self-hatred.
- Beyond the guards who are not quite people anymore, all the employees are trapped to some extent. Nataniel can explain the circumstances of his own deal with Destiny, but does not know that he can be released simply by someone reading his **manuscript** (see **Tier 4: The Manuscript**).
- Her lair is located under the building, and is accessible via an elevator in the highly restricted area. All guards carry the **passage gem** necessary to enter the zone. If asked about the orchid, he can confirm that it will likely be there.

This information can also be found in a journal that he keeps in his bedroom, through the door at the far end of his office. A **shortsword** smuggled for him by an employee is hidden under Nataniel's bed, which he may offer to the party.

DESTINY'S OFFICE

Searching the room's drawers and cabinets reveals **Destiny's Herbarium**, a spare **passage gem**, and a ledger keeping track of the debt racked up by Destiny's most high profile clients. Some of these debts are not to be repaid in gold, but in other forms of sacrifice: a patch of their skin, a secret, a vial of blood, etc. A character standing in plain sight on the balcony will be spotted by the crowd of attendees below.

DESTINY'S HERBARIUM

This thin leather bound book bears a sigil on the cover. On a successful **DC 12 Intelligence (Arcana) check**, the sigils remind of abjuration magic. This herbarium will come into play to disable the Sigil Wards in the lair (see **Tier 4: Sigil Wards**). On each page, a different plant or flower is pressed. Underneath are written plant names associated to creatures:

<i>Wild Snapdragon - wyvern</i>	<i>Silver aconite - lycans</i>	<i>Naive Myrtle - dryad</i>
<i>Southern Valerian - ogre</i>	<i>Lazare Orchid - sprite</i>	<i>Rot Aster - coven sisters</i>
<i>Common waxflower - will-o'-wisp</i>	<i>Bleeding Carnation - vampires</i>	<i>Chrysanthemum - shadow</i>
<i>Spotted hydrangea - ghost</i>	<i>Winter Peony - doppelganger</i>	<i>Red Protea - succubus</i>

PROGRESSING TO TIER 4

Tier 3 concludes when the party enters Destiny's secret elevator. It is located within the highly restricted access area, which can be unlocked by pressing a passage gem into the slot near the doors. Alternatively, characters can disable the mechanism of the gem slot with a successful **DC 16 Dexterity (Thieves' tools) check**, or force them open with a successful **DC 18 Strength (Athletics) check**.

TIER 4

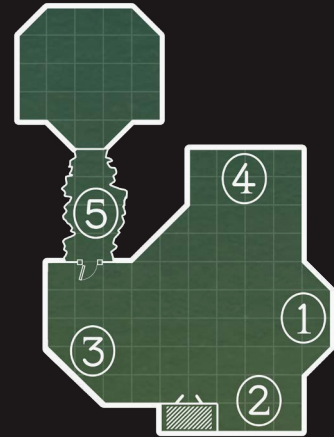
THE LAIR

DESTINY'S SECRET LAIR

The mechanical elevator leads into a damp stone basement faintly smelling of rot. Some of the walls are covered with vines and small carnivorous plants, while others are lined with shelves bearing odd jars, bottles and other containers.

Destiny's active spells are found in this room. Except for the Sleeping Room, which guards the path to the Vault, dispelling any of these will alert Destiny. If a spell is broken, the torches in the room turn red, and Destiny's voice is heard speaking through the mouths of the carnivorous plants in the room.

"Oh, darling... You really, really shouldn't have done that."



DESTINY'S ARRIVAL

Once alerted, it takes Destiny 2 minutes to arrive, accompanied by all security guards that are still alive. Should a fight erupt in this room, Destiny's tactics and priorities in combat remain unchanged (refer to **Tier 5: Resolution**). If Destiny is defeated, all her spells become inactive, and the Sleeping Room's curse is lifted, rendering it peaceful and harmless.

1. VICIOUS MIRRORS

Small mirror shards cover the eastern wall. They display the reflections of greenhouse visitors or party members whose insecurities were uncovered by the **vicious mirrors** (see **Tier 2: Preying on insecurities**). Pulsing silver veins link these shards to a centerpiece ornate mirror, displaying Destiny's reflection.

The vicious mirrors are linked to Destiny's mind via this centerpiece mirror. With an action, Destiny can think of a person and telepathically interrogate the mirrors. She learns all information that the mirrors collected on the chosen individual. If the centerpiece mirror is shattered, the spell and link are broken.

2. THE MANUSCRIPT

South of the room, a small chest contains **Nataniel's manuscript** and 3 vials of **liquid confidence**, which until the next long rest, grant a +3 bonus to Charisma saving throws.

4 years ago, hoping for Destiny to sponsor and publish his research, Nataniel pitched **liquid confidence**, a remedy that he created to ease self-doubt. She tricked him into a deal: *"until the world sees this writing, this lab will be your home and study"*. Soon after, she stole his work.

Nataniel is now trapped, unable to leave the labs. A character reading Nataniel's manuscript, therefore "seeing his writing", breaks the spell and sets him free.

3. FREEING THE TRUTH

A painting on the west wall of the chamber depicts the entire staff team of Destiny's Gardens. On the face of each staff member except for Destiny, Nataniel and the security guards, a lock of hair is pinned.

Upon hiring each employee, Destiny asked them to agree to a confidentiality clause, by entering a fairy bargain with her. Should they reveal anything about Destiny and her brand's true nature, they suffer 6d6 psychic damage.

Similarly to the fairy bargain issued by Pandora, burning these locks of hair will release the employees from their deal.

4. THE SIGIL WARDS

A full length mirror stands in a corner of the room. A sigil identical to the one on the cover of Destiny's Herbarium is painted on its surface with a thick ichor mixed with red petals. A bowl containing the same mixture, and a large glass bottle containing only the ichor, sit on a side table. Small jars of dried petals, each labeled with the name of a different plant from Destiny's Herbarium, are lined up on a nearby shelf. A successful DC 12 Intelligence (Nature) check reveals that the red petals are dried Lazare orchids. Having found Destiny's Herbarium grants advantage on this check.

The sigil on the mirror creates wards around the building, barring entry or exit, while the flowers mixed into the ichor determine what creatures are subjected to this spell. Since Lazare orchid petals are currently used, sprites cannot enter the building. Should the mirror be wiped, the wards are dispelled. In the background, Pandora and Ulberic, sensing the shift in magic, rush inside the greenhouse and attempt to join the group.

A character may set up new wards by mixing the flowers of their choice with the ichor, and drawing the sigil again on the mirror. The list of creatures and their corresponding flowers can be found in Destiny's Herbarium.

5. THE SLEEPING ROOM

At the far end of the room, a rotting wooden door leads into a dark space, that darkvision can not pierce. Instead of walls, floor or ceiling, the room is made of an ever so slightly moving mass of moss, meat and sinew. A raspy, cooing voice hums a wordless lullaby, accompanied by squelching fleshy sounds. It guards the path to Destiny's most precious belongings.

Any attempt to create or bring light into the space deeply upsets the room, which begins to shriek and slam its appendages against the offending character, and attempting to disable the source of light. The character must succeed on a DC 14 Dexterity Save or suffer 3d6 bludgeoning damage. As soon as the space is plunged into darkness again, the room calms down and resumes its lullaby.

SOLUTION

The room is not inherently hostile, but has been cursed by Destiny: light causes it great fear and pain. Acting similarly to a scared baby, it soothes itself with a lullaby. The party can gain the creature's trust by speaking softly to it, humming along to its lullaby, or by simply existing peacefully in its space and letting it get familiar with them. The room will then rearrange its own structure to let them through. Alternatively, the room is defeated if it receives a total of 60 damage. Should Destiny die, the curse ends and the room becomes harmless.

PROGRESSING TO TIER 5

Tier 4 concludes when the party enters the Vault either by solving the Sleeping Room puzzle or by defeating it in combat. Alternatively, should Destiny be alerted and on her way before the players enter the Vault, tier 4 concludes upon her arrival in the lair.

THE STOLEN ORCHID

Destiny keeps her most precious belongings in this small study, including the stolen orchid. It sits in a pot in the far end of the room, under a glass bell jar. Taking a closer look at the flower reveals small iridescent eggs faintly glowing beneath the petals. Characters who were unaware of the orchid's true nature and succeed on a **DC 14 Intelligence (Arcana) check** can recognize the small outline of the bodies within the eggs as sprites. Characters searching this study can also find a small chest with 800 gp worth of jewelry, gems and coins.

CLAIMING THE ORCHID'S POWER

A crystal alembic, a mortar and pestle, and well as an opened letter rest on a table near the orchid:

"Destiny dear,

The audacity in your letter was a risk. Lucky for you, the success you have found in your recent endeavors shows that risk suits you well. If nothing else, then at least for my own curiosity and amusement, I will grant your request. Best results come once the little ones have hatched, but don't dally either. Let it age too long, and it will lose its innocence much too fast for our purposes. If in a hurry, grinding the egg will do, though at the cost of some potency in the final result. For each dose, crush five of the wee babes (or eggs) in a mortar, and gather the resulting paste in my alembic: it will do the lion's share of the work, and accelerate the process. Fold your paste with the tallow before distilling, and keep the heat high. Your oil of youth and beauty can be applied on the skin, or swallowed while still liquid, it's all the same in the end. I look forward to seeing the fruits of your labour, and what you will do with a product of such potency and rarity. I would urge you not to forget this favour."

Following these steps and distilling one sprite egg creates a dose of **youth oil**. Once consumed, it grants the character a permanent +2 bonus to charisma, allowing them to reset their apparent age to that of their choice. There are enough eggs for 7 doses.

FIGHTING DESTINY

Unless all her husk minions have been defeated, Destiny never walks into a fight alone. If caught unaccompanied and entirely by surprise, she tries to buy some time in order to telepathically summon her husk minions. Hiding her anger behind a diplomatic smile, Destiny first attempts to bargain. She consults her **vicious mirrors** for any knowledge she may use in order to offer a targeted deal. For example, an ill character may be offered a cure. Without any specific information, she offers each character a dose of **youth oil**, in exchange for entering a fairy bargain, preventing them from speaking of the true nature of her operations without taking 6d6 psychic damage.

Should combat occur, Destiny stays close to her husk minions, using her **Girlboss** trait to let them take hits in her stead. She uses her spell to incapacitate or restrain her opponents, making them more vulnerable to her and her husk minions' attacks. If reduced to a third of her total hit points, she prioritizes getting away alive over saving her cover and her business. She uses her invisible passage trait to flee safely.

Depending on the spells that the party disabled in the Lair, Nataniel or the sprites may join and help in combat. Nataniel's priority is helping the party defeat Destiny, while the sprites' priority is securing the eggs.

OPTIONAL EVENT: THE MIRACLE OF LIFE

The eggs are ready to hatch, causing the flower to bloom and glow. Sprites being creatures inherently filled with magic, their birth causes fey energy to flood the area. Roll on the table at the beginning of each round to determine an environmental effect caused by the orchid blooming.

1d6	Environmental effect
1	A harmless sensory effect fills the room: echoing children's laughter, faintly glowing wisps floating in the air, or illusory butterflies.
2	For the next minute, all creatures within the room can now understand plants. The vines on the walls are repeatedly screaming "WATER".
3	One random creature in the room can no longer speak until the end of their next turn. Whenever they try, butterflies escape their mouth.
4	The creature nearest to the orchid regains 1d10 hit points.
5	A random creature is targeted by the <i>Invisibility</i> spell.
6	Faerie fire is cast in a 5-foot radius around the orchid.

EPILOGUES

Destiny's defeat causes a scandal in town. As the employees are free to finally talk of what truly happened behind the scenes, the ripples on some of her clients' reputations are disastrous. The supply of products abruptly stops, but withdrawal symptoms will eventually fade away. Seeing daylight for the first time in years, and eternally thankful to the party, Nataniel works to rebuild his life. He does his best to provide his assistance whenever he can. His knowledge as a researcher, and the healing properties of the remedies that he creates could be of use.

Escorted by Ulberic and Pandora, the sprite babies are ready to go home, where the tale of the party's good deed spreads fast. Should the group ever need the assistance or knowledge of the sprite tribe, they will be ready to answer the call.

But if the party chose to join Destiny's side and enter a deal with her, her wealth, influence and resources make her a very powerful ally. Though her patronage comes at a price (her goal remains to corrupt), she pays well on quests to fetch new ingredients or silence stray witnesses.

Characters who chose to claim the sprite eggs' power for themselves will have to face the wrath of the tribe. Soon, Ulberic and Pandora will relate the news to their whole community, who swear to return tenfold the harm that was done to their children.

APPENDIX

APPENDIX 1. STAT BLOCKS

DESTINY

Medium Fey, Neutral Evil

Armor Class 17 (natural armor)
Hit points 82 (11d8 + 33)
Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	12 (+1)	16 (+3)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	18 (+4)

Skills Arcana +3, Deception +8, Insight +4, Perception +4, Persuasion +6

Senses Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 14

Languages Common, Abyssal, Infernal, Sylvan

Challenge 4 (1100 XP)

Gaslight. As long as they are on the same plane of existence, Destiny can send telepathic messages to her husk minions.

Gatekeep. Destiny is immune to any effect that would sense her emotions or read her thoughts. Wisdom (Insight) checks made to ascertain Destiny's intentions or sincerity have disadvantage.

Girlboss. When a creature Destiny can see targets her with an attack, she chooses one of her husk minions within 5 feet of her. The two of them swap places, and the chosen husk minion becomes the target instead.

Innate Spellcasting. Destiny's innate spellcasting ability is Charisma (spell save DC 14, +6 to hit with spell attacks). She can innately cast the following spells, requiring no material components:

At will: *acid splash, druidcraft, vicious mockery*
2/day each: *charm person, detect thoughts, entangle, hideous laughter*
1/day each: *bestow curse, command, fear*

Speak with Plants. Destiny can communicate with plants as if they shared a language.

Spider climb. Destiny can climb difficult surfaces, including upside down on ceilings, without needing to make an ability check.

Actions

Fresh manicure. *Melee weapon attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 11 (2d8 + 2) slashing damage.

Judgemental side eye. Destiny targets one creature she can see within 60 feet of her. If the target can see Destiny, it must succeed on a DC 12 Wisdom saving throw against this magic or become frightened until the end of Destiny's next turn. If the target fails the saving throw by 5 or more, it is also paralyzed for the same duration. A target that succeeds on the saving throw is immune to this effect for the next 24 hours.

Invisible Passage. Destiny magically turns invisible until she attacks or casts a spell, or until her concentration ends (as if concentrating on a spell). While invisible, she leaves no physical evidence of her passage, so she can be tracked only by magic. Any equipment she wears or carries is invisible with her.

SECURITY GUARD

Medium Monstrosity, Unaligned

Armor Class 12
Hit points 22 (5d8)
Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	15 (+1)	10 (+0)	7 (-2)	8 (-1)	6 (-2)

Skills Athletics +3, Intimidation +1, Perception +1

Damage Immunities poison

Condition Immunities charmed, exhaustion, poisoned

Senses Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 11

Languages Common

Challenge 1 (200 XP)

Actions

Baton. *Melee weapon attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 4 (1d4 + 2) bludgeoning damage.

Bite (mask off only). *Melee weapon attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 9 (2d6 + 2) piercing damage. The target must succeed on a DC 10 Constitution saving throw or be paralyzed until the end of their next turn.

Claws (gloves off only). *Melee weapon attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 7 (2d4 + 2) slashing damage. The target must succeed on a DC 10 Constitution saving throw or be paralyzed until the end of their next turn.

EMPLOYEE

Medium Humanoid, True Neutral

Armor Class 11
Hit points 15 (3d8)
Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS
10 (+0)	12 (+1)	10 (+0)	16 (+3)	14 (+2)

CHA

Skills Arcana +5, Medicine +4, Nature +5, Perception +4 12 (+1)
Senses Passive Perception 14
Languages Common
Challenge 1/4 (50 XP)

Fairy Bargain. If the employee reveals, whether by speech, writing or otherwise, information about the true nature of Destiny or her company, they immediately suffer 6d6 psychic damage.

Spellcasting. The employee's spellcasting ability is Intelligence (spell save DC 12, +4 to hit with spell attacks). They can innately cast the following spells, requiring no material components:

Cantrips (at will): *acid splash, mage hand, minor illusion*
 1st level (3 slots): *expeditious retreat, fog cloud, identify, mage armor*

Actions

Improvised weapon. *Melee weapon attack:* +1 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 3 (1d4 + 1) bludgeoning damage.

DR NATANIEL MIRVILLE

Medium Humanoid, Neutral good

Armor Class 12
Hit points 20 (4d8)
Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS
10 (+0)	12 (+2)	10 (+0)	16 (+3)	14 (+2)

Skills Arcana +5, Medicine +4, Nature +5, Perception +4
Senses Passive Perception 14
Languages Common
Challenge 1/4 (50 XP)

Laboratory Bound. For every turn that he spends outside of the labs, Nataniel suffers 3d6 psychic damage.

Spellcasting. Nataniel's spellcasting ability is Intelligence (spell save DC 12, +4 to hit with spell attacks). He can innately cast the following spells, requiring no material components:

Cantrips (at will): *dancing lights, guidance, poison spray, produce flame*
 1st level (4 slots): *bless, comprehend languages, cure wounds, detect magic, detect poison and disease, entangle, goodberry, healing word*
 2nd level (3 slots): *lesser restoration, locate animals or plants, protection from poison*

Actions

Scalpel. *Melee weapon attack:* +2 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 4 (1d4 + 2) slashing damage.



APPENDIX

APPENDIX 2. DESTINY'S MAGICAL PRODUCTS

On top of a **+1 bonus to Charisma** resulting from a "boost in confidence", each one of Destiny's products provides a different minor buff and cosmetic change. Each dose is effective for 3 days, after which the effects are replaced by withdrawal symptoms.

During this withdrawal phase, the character's perception of their own appearance is altered. While their appearance is exactly the same as it was before the magic of Destiny's product takes effect, in their mind, the "flaw" that they sought to correct seems to have returned even more prominent. With their confidence impacted, they suffer a -1 penalty to their Charisma. By default, this withdrawal period lasts one day. However, it extends to 3 days for characters who have used products for at least 3 consecutive days.

Each dose costs 50 gp. When the party encounters Destiny's magical products, roll or choose from the following table:

Product	Effect
Volumizing hair oil	After rubbing this oil on their scalp, the character's hair becomes curlier, proportionally to the amount of product used. The character gains advantage on Charisma (performance) checks.
Eloquence drops	The voice of a character who ate one of these lozenges grows more clear and convincing, granting advantage on Charisma (Persuasion) checks.
Muscle growth balm	Applying this balm to one's body enhances the appearance and definition of muscles. It grants advantage to Strength (Athletics) checks.
Perfect iris eye drops	After application, one's eye color changes to the color of their choice, granting a +2 bonus to Passive Perception and Wisdom (Perception) checks.
Cheeky lip scrub	After applying this product, the user's lips become more rosy, smooth and full. The character gains a +2 bonus to Charisma (Deception) checks.
Soft Hands cream	Applying this cream to hands turns them smoother, softer to the touch, and more nimble, granting a +2 bonus to Dexterity (Sleight of hand) checks.

APPENDIX 3. CAFÉ MENU

CAFÉ MENU

All pastries and drinks on our menu are homemade, and will alter your appearance for a day. Enjoy!

Coffee (*eye color change*)
Hot chocolate (*longer hair*)
Fruit juice (*streak of color in hair*)
White chocolate & raspberry cookie (*longer lashes*)
Pear crumble (*freckles*)
Lemon lavender shortbread (*mole on cheek*)

APPENDIX 4. OPENED LETTER

Destiny dear,

The audacity in your letter was a risk.

Lucky for you, the success you have found in your recent endeavors shows that risk suits you well. If nothing else, then at least for my own curiosity and amusement, I will grant your request.

Best results come once the little ones have hatched, but don't dally either. Let it age too long, and it will lose its innocence much too fast for our purposes. If in a hurry, grinding the egg will do, though at the cost of some potency in the final result.

For each dose, crush five of the wee babes (or eggs) in a mortar, and gather the resulting paste in my alembic: it will do the lion's share of the work, and accelerate the process. Fold your paste with the tallow before distilling, and keep the heat high. Your oil of youth and beauty can be applied on the skin, or swallowed while still liquid, it's all the same in the end.

I look forward to seeing the fruits of your labour, and what you will do with a product of such potency and rarity. I would urge you not to forget this favour.